

Category Design Map

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Create and own a new category

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Category Design Map guides a company in creating and owning a new market category, rather than competing within an existing one, by defining the problem and the category it solves.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Articulated by Al Ramadan, Dave Peterson, Christopher Lochhead and Kevin Maney in Play Bigger (2016).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed on the observation that category creators capture a disproportionate share of a category's value.

FIGURE 1 · CATEGORY DESIGN MAP

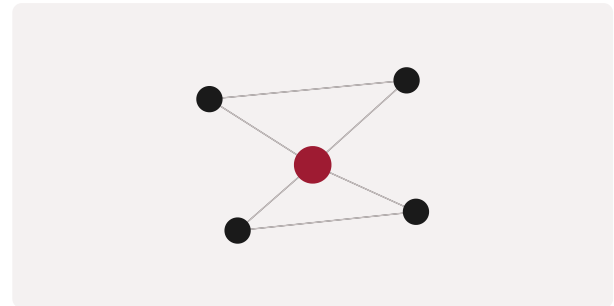


Figure 1. A schematic of the Category Design Map as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The company defines a new category, frames the problem it addresses, and invests in making the category — and itself as its leader — known.

WHEN IT IS USED

When an AI venture can define and lead a new category.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, marketing and strategy leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It reframes competition as category creation, where defining the game can be more valuable than winning an existing one.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Ramadan, A. et al. (2016) Play Bigger. New York: Harper Business.

Lochhead, C. and Peterson, D. (2018) Niche Down. Self-published.